

CHEN, Mingyang

Macau, China | Postal Code: 999078 | mc55649@um.edu.mo
[\[Personal Website\]](#)

EDUCATION

University of Macau (UM) | Macau, China

M.S.S. in Criminology and Criminal Justice | 08/2025 – 06/2027 (*expected*)

- GPA: 4.0/4.0
- Thesis: *On Machine Learning and the Criminal Justice System*, Supervised by Dr. Bo Jiang

China University of Political Science and Law (CUPL) | Beijing, China

LL.B. in Law | 09/2021 – 07/2025

- GPA: 89.88/100 (*rank in the top 5%*)
- University-level Honors Thesis (*in Chinese*), Supervised by Dr. Boyang Xu

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Criminal Justice Decision-Making; Plea Leniency and Plea Bargaining; Empirical Legal Research; AI and Law; Criminal Law

PEER-REVIEW PUBLICATIONS

Publications in English

Mingyang Chen, Shujian Lin, Boyang Xu (In press). Does Plea Leniency Lead to Higher Crime Rates by Lowering Conviction Standards? A Quasi-Experimental Analysis in China. *Asian Journal of Comparative Law*, 21(1). (*Asia Leading Law Journal*)

Mingyang Chen, Gaojie Song, Zhipeng Wu, Zhanxue Xu, Boyang Xu (2026). Judges are Trained as Good Explainers but Maligned Sentencers: A Text Similarity Approach. *Law Probability & Risk*, 25(1), mgag007 (*SSCI/SCI Q1*) [Link](#)

Mingyang Chen, Zhipeng Wu (2026). Machine Judges Reduce Sentencing Bias? A Computational Social Science Evaluation. *The 40th AAAI: Bridge Between AI and Law*, 43-50. (*CORE Computer Science A+ Proceedings*) [Link](#)

Publications in Chinese

Mingyang Chen, Yantong Guo, Boyang Xu, Dai Li. (2025). The Dichotomous Classification of Special Schools: An Empirical Test Based on Social Control Theory. *Journal of Postgraduates - CUPL*, 20(1), 197-223. [Link](#)

WRITINGS

Work in Progress

Wenqiang Bao, Shujian Lin, **Mingyang Chen**. Convergent Practices, Divergent Causes: The Apparent Americanization and Local Logic of China's Plea Leniency System.

Report

Dai Li, **Mingyang Chen**, Tong Xue, Qingfeng Liu. (2025). How Can the Market-Oriented Reform of Arbitration Institutions Enhance the Credibility of Arbitration Awards? Evidence from 76 Arbitration Institutions in China. (*Report in Chinese; Funding from China Arbitration Institute's Credibility of Arbitration Project*)

CONFERENCE PAPERS

Oral Presentations

Mingyang Chen (01/2026). Machine Judges Reduce Sentencing Bias? A Computational Social Science Evaluation. **The 40th Annual AAAI Conference: Bridge between AI and Law**, Singapore | **Award: Best Paper Award Honorable Mention** (4/52, *Sponsored by Axon Enterprise, Inc.*)

Mingyang Chen (07/2025). Criminal Justice Theory, Empirical Study, Machine Learning and Judge Decision-Making. **The 7th Towards Data Law/Empirical Legal Research Conference**, Hangzhou, China

Shujian Lin. (07/2026). Convergent Practices, Divergent Causes: The Apparent Americanization and Local Logic of China's Plea Leniency System. **The 9th Towards Data Law/Empirical Legal Research Conference**, Beijing, China

Shujian Lin (07/2025). Does Plea Leniency Lead to Higher Crime Rates by Lowering Conviction Standards? A Quasi-Experimental Analysis in China. **The 11th International Conference on Law and Economics**, CUPL, Beijing, China

Gaojie Song (11/2024). Combining Empirical Legal Study and Machine Learning to Improve Judge Decision-Making (*in Chinese*). **Tianjin Law Society Applied Law Branch 2024 Annual Conference**, Tianjin, China | **Award: First Prize Paper**

Accepted (Not Presented)

Mingyang Chen (12/2024). The Dichotomous Classification of Special Schools: An Empirical Test Based on Social Control Theory (*in Chinese*). **Seminar on Punishment and Prevention of Juvenile Delinquency**, Chongqing, China | **Award: Excellent Prize Paper**

SOFTWARE

Mingyang Chen, Zhipeng Wu (2026). *Chinese.legalText: A Package for Analyzing CJO Criminal Documents*. R package version 1.0.1. [Link](#)

INDUSTRIAL ACTIVITIES & TALKS

Tencent Research Institute AI&Society Camp 2026 | Beijing, China

Research Sharing Track | 10/2026

- Share our research on AI and Sentencing Decisions. (*Supported by Tencent Co., Ltd*)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Project Leader

Law Experiment Competition, CUPL Data Law Lab | Beijing, China

Project Leader | 03/2025

- Summary: *Developing a Sentencing Prediction Model*
- Award: First Prize Work (*rank 4/240; the only undergraduate-led team getting the first prize*).
- Contributions: Conceptualization; literature review; built a stacking model; built rules for feature extraction; writing – original draft
- Funding: CUPL Data Law Lab's Funding for Law Experiment Model Competition (CNY10,000)
- Outcome: a conference presentation at *Tianjin Law Society Applied Law Branch 2024 Annual Conference*, a publication on *Law Probability & Risk*

National Undergraduate Research Training Project | Beijing, China

Project Leader | 09/2022 – 09/2023

- Summary: *Investigating the Marital Experiences of Tongqi (Wives of Gay Men), with a Focus on IPV*
- Supervisor: Dr. Ai Ma
- Score: 95/100 (rank 1/101). Evaluated as "Excellent Work" by the committee.
- Contributions: Conceptualization; literature review; interviewed 22 Tongqi; writing – original draft
- Funding: National Undergraduate Research Training Project (202210053038) (CNY10,000)

Collaboration

Procedural Law Research Institute, CUPL | Beijing, China (remote)

Research Collaborator & Co-author | 09/2025 – Present

- Summary: *Investigating Plea Leniency's Real Effect using Mixed Methods*
- Project Leader: Dr. Wenqiang Bao
- Contributions: Conceptualization; quantitative data analysis; designed interview questionnaires and outlines; writing – review & editing
- Funding: China University of Political Science and Law's Support Scheme for Young Academics' Innovative Research Teams (24CXTD06)
- Outcome: a conference presentation at the *9th Towards Data Law/Empirical Legal Research Conference*

Research Assistance

China Arbitration Institute, CUPL | Beijing, China

Research Assistant & Co-author | 03/2025 – 07/2025

- Summary: *Evaluating China's Market-Oriented Reform on Arbitration Institution*
- Project Leader: Dr. Tong Xue; Supervisor: Dr. Tong Xue & Dr. Dai Li
- Contributions: Data analysis; literature review; writing – original draft
- Funding: China Arbitration Institute's Credibility of Arbitration Project
- Outcome: a report in Chinese

School of Criminal Justice, CUPL | Beijing, China

Research Assistant | 09/2024 – 02/2025

- Summary: *Investigating Factors Influencing Judicial Trust in China*
- Project Leader: Dr. Boyang Xu
- Contributions: Collected province-level crime data and control variables data
- Funding: Philosophy and Social Science Foundation of China (24CFX098)
- Outcome: Contributed data to a paper by Dr. Boyang Xu in *China Law Review (in Chinese)*; data further used in a first-authored article in the *Asian Journal of Comparative Law*.

School of Criminal Justice, CUPL | Beijing, China

Research Assistant | 03/2024 – 08/2024

- Summary: *Testing Criminology Theories in China*
- Project Leader: Dr. Xuelian Zhao; Co-Leader: Dr. Boyang Xu
- Contributions: Questionnaire design; conducted surveys in two provinces
- Funding: Annual Project of China Youth & Children Research Association (2024B12)
- Outcome: Data further used in a first-authored article in the *Journal of Postgraduates - CUPL*, co-authored

with RA Yantong Guo.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Famao Technology Co., Ltd | Beijing, China

Legal Knowledge Engineer Intern | 06/2024 – 08/2024

- Supervised by Product Manager: Mr. Changrui Liu
- Developed an automatic data search engine for legal professionals with computer scientists.

ZHONGYIN Law Firm | Fuzhou, China

Criminal Lawyer Intern | 07/2023 – 08/2023

- Supervised by Senior Partner: Mr. Bin Feng
- Drafted legal documents for defendants.
- Collected and organized materials, including related legal provisions and judicial documents.

LEADERSHIP & VOLUNTARY ACTIVITIES

School of Criminal Justice, CUPL | Beijing, China

Undergrad. Teaching Assistant of Spring Semester | 03/2024 – 07/2024

- Assisted Dr. Boyang Xu

Student Committee, CUPL | Beijing, China

Student Committee Minister | 07/2022 – 07/2023

Western Volunteers Association, CUPL | Xinzhou, China (remote)

Teaching Volunteer - Art Teacher | 02/2023 – 03/2023

Volunteer Department of CUPL Student Committee | Quzhou, China (remote)

Teaching Volunteer - Art Teacher | 01/2022 – 02/2022

REWARDS AND GRANTS

Second Prize Paper (MOP800), UM Postgraduate Association Paper Competition | 03/2026

Best Paper Award Honorable Mention, the 40th AAAI Bridge Program | 01/2026

Student Travel Funding (MOP2,000), UM Faculty of Social Science | 01/2026

Third Prize Scholarship (CNY1,000), CUPL | 12/2024

Excellent Prize Paper, Chongqing Procuratorate | 12/2024

First Prize Paper, Tianjin Law Society Applied Law Branch | 11/2024

First Prize Winner; Grant (CNY10,000), Law Experiment Model Competition | 09/2024

Second Prize Scholarship (CNY2,000), CUPL | 12/2023

First Prize Scholarship (CNY3,000), CUPL | 12/2022

Grant (CNY10,000), National Undergraduate Research Training Project | 09/2022 – 09/2023

SKILLS

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent, IELTS 7.5), Taiwanese/Hokkien (Native)

Software: R, Python, , $\text{L}^{\text{A}}\text{T}_{\text{E}}\text{X}$, MS Office

Certificate: China Legal Professional Qualification Certificate

Standardized Tests: GRE 334 (V164+Q170), China Judicial Examination (197+121)